



SA



AIDEN MARKRAM



ICC MEN'S T20
WORLD CUP
INDIA & SRI LANKA 2026

SEMI FINAL 1




SOUTH AFRICA VS NEW ZEALAND

WEDNESDAY, 4 MARCH | 7:00 PM
EDEN GARDENS, KOLKATA

NZ



MITCHELL SANTNER

ZEALOUS ZEALAND JAFFAS THE SAFFAS AT EDEN

The platinum members of the We Five Kolkata Sporting Enthusiasts a.k.a. the **Spandanish Supreme Slayers**, were in attendance at the highly octance, thrilling Semi-Final match of the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 between **South Africa** and **New Zealand** at the Eden Gardens, Kolkata.



South Africa, led by Aiden Markram, were the only unbeaten side in this tournament having secured the pole position in Group A of the Super 8 stage by defeating India, West Indies and Zimbabwe.

New Zealand, on the other hand, under the captaincy of Mitchell Santner, finished 2nd in Group B, by brushing off Pakistan through Net Run Rate. Their match against Pakistan was washed out, while they convincingly defeated Sri Lanka, but were defeated by England in the game prior to coming into this match.

Eden has become a high-scoring venue of late, and the pitch was decently similar as expected. Santner won the toss and put SA into bat, however the latter had a

forgettable start losing two quick wickets to Cole McConchie in the second over. They never really got going ever since then, and a late blitz by Jansen helped them to a fighting total of 169.

New Zealand openers, **also part of KKR this year**, Tim Seifert and Finn Allen made light-work of the chase by mustering 80 for no-loss in the PowerPlay. They unleashed a wide variety of attacking shots against a seemingly clue-less bowling attack. SA got a late consolation wicket of Seifert, but that was all joy for them, as Allen made a majestic 33-ball 100, breaking C.H.Gayle's record of fastest T20 World Cup century, to take his side over the line.

We were witness to history being created, as the 50000-odd spectators, and surely many more at home, cheered on the moment. And what better place than the iconic Eden Gardens!

In the other Semi Final at Mumbai, India narrowly edged out England, by 7 runs, in a high scoring thriller with 499 runs scored across both innings. This sets up a repeat of the Champions Trophy 2025 Final, India vs New Zealand, at Ahmedabad on 8th March, 2026.

The Eden Gardens never fails to mesmerise and this was just one more such occasion. Looking forward to the next visit, until then, cheerio!

